🌱 FFA & Ag Careers: Reading · ANSWER KEY

Ag Science 1 · Unit 4 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Communications: FFA What You Need to Know, Creed, CDE/LDE, Ag Explorer Career Finder

Name: _____

What FFA Is and Why It Matters

FFA started in 1928 as the Future Farmers of America. In 1988 the name changed to the National FFA Organization, because FFA is not just for farmers. Its mission is to make a positive difference in students' lives through premier leadership, personal growth and career success.

Agricultural education uses a three-circle model: classroom instruction (ag class), the SAE or Supervised Agricultural Experience (a hands-on ag project), and FFA (leadership and contests). The student is in the middle where all three meet.

FFA's colors are National Blue, from the blue field of the U.S. flag, and Corn Gold, from fields of ripe corn. The motto is: Learning to Do, Doing to Learn, Earning to Live, Living to Serve. Official dress is the zipped blue FFA jacket, a white collared shirt with an FFA tie or scarf, black pants or skirt and black shoes.

The FFA emblem has six parts: the corn (unity), the rising sun (progress), the plow (hard work), the eagle (freedom), the owl (wisdom) and the words FFA and Agricultural Education. Members earn degrees: Discovery, Greenhand, Chapter, State and American. For the Greenhand degree, members learn the Creed, mission, motto, colors and emblem. The Creed has five paragraphs that begin “I believe.”

CDEs (Career Development Events) test job skills like livestock judging, vet science and ag mechanics. LDEs (Leadership Development Events) include public speaking and job interviews. The Ag Explorer Career Finder asks about your interests and suggests careers such as veterinarian, welder, farrier, scientist or ag teacher.

Check your reading

1. Why did the name change to the National FFA Organization?
FFA is not just for farmers; it covers all of agriculture and leadership.

2. Name the three circles of ag education.
Classroom, SAE, FFA.

3. What is the difference between a CDE and an LDE?
CDE tests career/job skills; LDE tests leadership skills like public speaking.